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Homeward Bound

AS I hear of the terrible calamities that from week to week are taking place, I ask myself, What do these things mean? The most awful disasters are following one another in quick succession. How frequently we hear of earthquakes and tornadoes, of destruction by fire and flood, with great loss of life and property! Apparently these calamities are capricious outbreaks of seemingly disorganised, unregulated forces, but in them God's purpose may be read. They are one of the means by which He seeks to arouse men and women to a sense of their danger.

The coming of Christ is nearer than when we first believed. The great controversy is nearing its end. The judgments of God are in the land. They speak in solemn warning, saying, "Be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh." Matt. 24 : 44.

But there are many, many in our churches who know little of the real meaning of the truth for this time. I appeal to them not to disregard the fulfilling of the signs of the times, which say so plainly that the end is near. O, how many who have not sought their souls' salvation will soon make the bitter lamentation, "The harvest is past, the summer is ended, and my soul is not saved!"

We are living in the closing scenes of this earth's history. Prophecy is fast fulfilling. The hours of probation are fast passing. We have no time—not a moment—to lose. Let us not be found sleeping on guard. Let no one say in his heart or by his works, "My Lord delayeth His coming." Let the message of Christ's soon return sound forth in earnest words of warning. Let us persuade men and women everywhere to repent, and flee from the wrath to come. Let us arouse them to immediate preparation; for we little know what is before us. Let ministers and lay members go forth into the ripening fields, to tell the unconcerned and indifferent to seek the Lord while He may be found. The workers will find their harvest wherever they proclaim the forgotten truths of the Bible. They will find those who will accept the truth and will devote their lives to winning souls to Christ.

The Lord is soon to come, and we must be prepared to meet Him in peace. Let us be determined to do all in our power to impart light to those around us. We are not to be sad, but cheerful, and we are to keep the Lord Jesus ever before us. He is soon coming, and we must be ready and waiting for His appearing. O, how glorious it will be to see Him, and be welcomed as His redeemed ones! Long have we waited; but our hope is not to grow dim. If we can but see the King in His beauty, we shall be forever blessed. I feel as if I must cry aloud, "Homeward bound!" We are nearing the time

The Day of Days

My day of days is without name
  Among the gala days of earth;
No festival of ancient fame,
  Or day when nation had its birth;
No place in human annals given,
  Its dawn no pen can yet portray;
But in the Calendar of Heaven,
  It bears the name "Translation Day."

Unseen, but drawing swiftly nigh,
  It brings the rapturous moment strange,
When in the twinkling of an eye
  This flesh shall make the great exchange;
When Life shall turn its mortal page,
  And I shall greet the life sublime,
Where youth shall live its golden age
  Fore'er beyond the touch of Time.

O, how shall thrill this mortal frame
  When like a meteor through the air,
The angel trumpet shall proclaim
  The end of sorrow, pain, and care,—
When Time shall give his sceptre o'er,
  And Death, archfoe of humankind,
The monster that now looms before,
  Shall be forever left behind!

A higher law, a stronger power
  Than hold me to this fallen sphere,
Shall draw me upward at that hour;
  And my glad feet, once lifted clear
From this abode of crime and tears,
  Where hopes deceive and pleasures pain,
Shall never through eternal years
  Rest on its sin-cursed soil again.

For this we hope, for this we pray—
The coming of Translation Day.

LEON A. SMITH.

when Christ will come in power and great glory to take His ransomed ones to their eternal home.

"It shall be said in that day, Lo, this is our God; we have waited for Him, and He will save us: this is the Lord; we have waited for Him, we will be glad and rejoice in His salvation." Isa. 25:9.

"Go through, go through the gates; prepare ye the way of the people; cast up, cast up the highway; gather out the stones; lift up a standard for the people. Behold, the Lord hath proclaimed unto the end of the world, Say ye to the daughter of Zion, Behold, thy salvation cometh; behold, His reward is with Him, and His work before Him. And they shall call them, The holy people, The redeemed of the Lord: and thou shalt be called, Sought out, A city not forsaken." Isa. 62:10-12.

In the great closing work we shall meet with perplexities that we know not how to deal with; but let us not forget that the three great powers of heaven are working, that a divine hand is on the wheel, and that God will bring His promises to pass. He will gather from the world a people who will serve Him in righteousness.

"Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in Me. In My Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you. And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto Myself; that where I am, there ye may be also." John 14:1-3.

Long have we waited for our Saviour's return. But none the less sure is the promise. Soon we shall be in our promised home. There Jesus will lead us beside the living stream, flowing from the throne of God, and will explain to us the dark providences through which on this earth He brought us in order to perfect our characters. There we shall behold with undimmed vision the beauties of Eden restored. Casting at the feet of the Redeemer the crowns that He has placed on our heads, and touching our golden harps, we shall fill all heaven with praise to Him that sitteth on the throne. MRS. E. G. WHITE.

The Fulness of God

ON the last day of the Union Conference, the Bible study at the 9.30 hour was conducted by Brother C. H. Pretyman, who took for his text, John 1:16, and for his subject, the "Fulness of God." "And of His fulness have all we received, and grace for grace." Other texts reiterated the phrase, "the fulness of God," which was variously translated by Weymouth and the Twentieth Century, "the whole of the divine perfections," and "the divine nature in all its fulness." The speaker presented his subject under four heads,—the fulness, the tense of the verb, the recipients, and the measure and manner of bestowing.

A most helpful study of the life of Joseph once again revealed how he was the antitype of Christ. God gave him "treasures of wisdom and knowledge," complete authority, full possessions, and a message to all lands. Gen. 41:39, 38, 44, 49, 54, 55. This measure of fulness was well illustrated by the reservoir which is ever overflowing yet is daily supplying the needs of a great city. The relation of man to Christ is also illustrated in the life of Joseph. Through Joseph was the only way to obtain corn, which was life (v. 55); and to obtain it, the people gave in turn their money, their cattle, their land, themselves. Gen. 47:14, 17, 20, 25. The speaker asked could we not say with the people of Egypt, "Thou hast saved our lives: . . . we will be [Thy] servants"? Gen. 47:25.

He then drew attention to the tense of the verb "have received," which is "perfect," signifying an action already completed. God accepted us in the Beloved, the inheritance of grace is ours, and we have but daily and hourly to draw as we need. The same "perfected" condition is taught in Eph. 1:3, 8, 9, 11.

Again, who are the recipients?—As many as receive Him. John 1:12. Herein is the secret of the victorious life. If we receive Christ, "the divine nature in all its fulness is for us. "Whatever we need is there. We give up all as did the Egyptians, and we receive all, according to this great abundance. The car cannot go without petrol and this needs to be constantly replenished. Prayer is the key in the hand of faith to unlock the storehouse of heaven. The most powerful argument for Christianity is a victorious Christian, but "a cheap Christian character works more harm in the world than the character of a worldling."—"*Testimonies*," *Vol. IX, p. 21.*

The speaker confessed that the last phrase "grace for grace" presented to him some difficulty of understanding until he read Fenton's translation "with gift heaped upon gift," which recalled to his mind the breakfast table piled with gifts on each childhood birthday. We have a spiritual birthday and moreover it is a daily one, as Paul said. "Paul had a new conversion every day and took an advance step towards heaven."—"*Testimonies*," *Vol. IV, pages 66, 67.* Just as often Christ piles gift upon gift for us. "Who daily loadeth us with benefits." Ps. 68:19. As in Joseph's day, none who came were turned away empty, so now "him that cometh unto Me, I will in no wise cast out."

News from Afar

Letter from China

DURING the Australasian Union Conference session in September, when the press cables revealed that the civil war and antiforeign uprisings in China were causing a very serious situation, and the lives of missionaries were in danger, special prayer was offered by the Conference assembled, and a cable message assuring them of our sympathy and prayers was sent to the headquarters in Shanghai of our Far Eastern Division. Writing October 28 in response to this cable message, Brother C. C. Crisler says:

"It was thoughtful of you to send the reassuring message during your quadrennial council: 'Australasian Union session praying for work and workers in China's dark hour.' This was passed on immediately to some of the leaders in the China field and elsewhere, and later to all through the columns of the *Outlook*. We have already had some grateful responses and now I must tell you how cheered we were over the receipt of this message.

"We are not yet out of the dark, but we do not expect to have an easy time hereafter in the China field. We must endure hardness as good soldiers and go forward rejoicing in the Lord's protection.

"I am glad to be able to tell you that the two families who were shut up in Sianfu for more than five months have been released and have just completed their journey out from Sianfu and through Central China to Shanghai. They reached us yesterday afternoon and are in fairly good health. The Lord has been merciful to these friends.

"We have no definite word from Chungking, Szechwan, aside from telegraphic information that the river is now open again and that recruits could be sent up if any were to come to Shanghai for service in West China.

"Central China is suffering in many ways, and the prospect is somewhat forbidding. Yet the men are pressing out to places that can be reached by them and they hope to reach still other places later on as the troops shift their positions and thus open the way into sections now held.

"May I express the hope that you may be greatly blessed in the Australasian Union during the coming four years, and see as the fruit of your labours a large ingathering from the faithful seed-sowing of past years. I have been going over your statistical records and it would seem to me that you have reached a point that some of the rest of us have reached in certain sections of the field, namely, the beginning of an abundant harvest of precious souls. This harvest, however, can be reaped only as we go into the fields in living faith, believing that the word of God that has been so faithfully sown will not return unto Him void. Those who reap must also be diligent in sowing, and we can expect a harvest only as we continue to sow and labour with all diligence and with an unfaltering faith."

THERE are souls perplexed with doubt, burdened with infirmities, weak in faith, and unable to grasp the Unseen; but a friend whom they can see, coming to them in Christ's stead, can be a connecting link to fasten their trembling faith upon Christ.—"*The Desire of Ages*," *p. 297.*

The New Hebrides Boat

THE New Hebrides boat is a strongly built auxiliary ketch with a nineteen horse-power engine of the Gardiner crude oil type. On our trial run to Levuka the engine propelled the boat along at the rate of six knots an hour. On our return home, using the sails and engine both, with a light breeze, we made a little over seven knots. Old Captain Steinbach, who was with us, and who will be in charge on the trip to the New Hebrides, says she is a good sea boat, and that he is very pleased with her performance. Using crude oil at the present prices the engine runs at one-third of the cost of a benzine engine of the same power.

We are very thankful that such good boats can be provided for our work here in the islands, as it will save us much inconvenience, and lessen the risks of travel over angry seas. The cabin is large, and has accommodation for four white persons, while the natives have a fine roomy hold forward. We have purchased a four-hundred-gallon tank to carry the water supply, and every provision is being made for safety.

Brother MacLaren will act as mate and engineer and have charge of the crew of four Fijian young men, on the voyage from Suva to the New Hebrides. We wish them a pleasant voyage as they go, and know the brethren in the homeland will join us in prayer for their safety.

H. R. MARTIN.

Closing Exercises, Indian Girls' School

SUNDAY, December 4, was a red-letter day in the experience of the pupils of our Indian Girls' School. This day marked not only the close of the school year but also the end of the first half-year of school life for many of the girls. For them it was a novel experience to stand before relatives and friends and bear their part in rendering items of a varied and interesting programme.

Promptly at 3 p.m. the children filed into their seats, followed later by mothers, brothers, and sisters. Quickly the little schoolroom was filled to overflowing, and the late-comers, of whom there were quite a number, were compelled to stand in the aisle and around the doors and windows.

Prior to leading the assemblage in prayer Brother N. B. Singh called upon the girls to sing as an opening exercise a Hindi translation of the hymn, "The Mothers of Salem." Words of welcome to parents and friends were spoken in the vernacular by a number of the older girls. A good friend of the school from Suva, Mr. S. S. Chowla, then read to the gathering a brief account of the work and objectives of the school. Some time was next devoted to recitation in English and Hindi by various classes and individual scholars, each item carrying a definite message of truth.

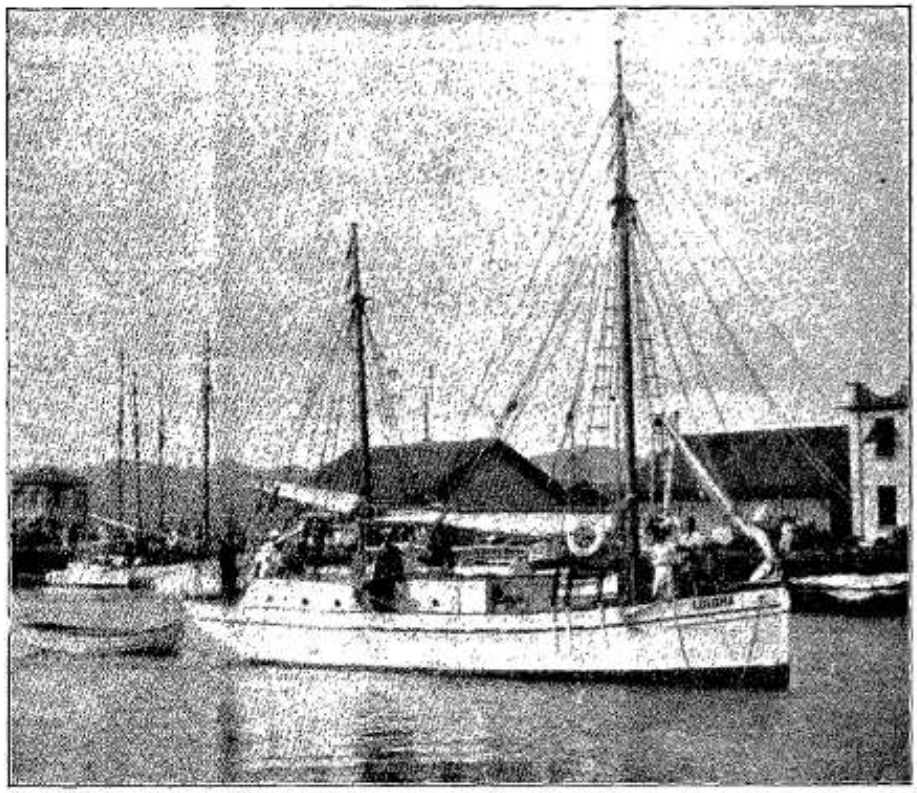
A brief report of the work of the girls in the examinations was given by the writer, followed by the presentation of grade cards to the children, several of whom have made rather remarkable progress during the half-year.

Methods of instruction followed by the teacher were described by Sister Meyers, who explained to interested parents her desire to impart spiritual and moral strength to the characters of the children. As an illustration of this several girls recited in Hindi and English a number of texts on virtue and true womanliness, as, "Who can find a virtuous woman? for her price is far above rubies (Prov. 31:10), which had been learned in the daily Bible study class. In similar ways effective instruction has been given from time to time. This has borne fruit in the gradual but certain disappearance of stealing, falsifying, and quarrelsomeness, and in the encouraging development of the spirit of forgiveness, confession of wrongdoing, and honesty.

An interesting and happy gathering was brought to a close with a distribution of gifts to the children, supplied to Sister Meyers by some kind friend in Australia.

Thus ended for Sister Meyers six months of arduous work, a period that has known its trials and perplexities, but also its joys and blessings. Seeds of truth have been tactfully and faithfully scattered in the expectation that some will spring forth into the fruit of everlasting life.

E. B. RUDGE.



The new cutter, "Loloma," in stream a few hours before sailing for Vila.

Our Nearest Mission Field

Lord Howe Island

WITHIN two days' sail from Sydney by steamer and in an almost easterly direction, is our nearest island mission field,—Lord Howe Island.

Its inhabitants, who number about 130, are mostly the descendants of the original settlers, and are a healthy, sturdy people who derive their livelihood from the sale of the famous Kentia palm seed and young plants, for the cultivation of which this island seems to be particularly adapted.

It is interesting to review the history of our work in this our nearest mission field. During a recent visit to the island, in company with Pastor Ross James, I was much interested in learning from Brother A. H. Ferris that nearly thirty years ago Pastor J. M. Cole, while travelling between Norfolk Island and New Zealand, spent a few days on Lord Howe and held some studies with the people. In fact, we sat in one of the very sitting rooms on this occasion where some of those studies were held and where the truth has subsequently been established in the hearts of these dear people.

Some years later Brother C. D. Baron visited the island, and his visit is also spoken of by the older members of the community. But it was after Brother Ferris, who with his family was residing on Norfolk Island, had spent some time on Lord Howe and held a series of meetings with the people that definite results were seen.

Owing to Brother Ferris having to return to Norfolk Island, his appeal for help to the Union Conference was responded to in the appointment of Brother

C. K. Meyers and wife to labour there for a time, and this led to still a larger number becoming deeply interested. Pastor E. S. Butz then visited the island to baptise the believers and organise them into a church. With the presentation of the plain truths of the requirements of true church fellowship, some felt the way too hard and the cross too heavy; but others fully accepted the principles of the remnant church and were subsequently established as an organised body. Brother and Sister Robinson from Victoria connected with this church for a time as self-supporting workers.

After the departure of these labourers Brother S. Nobbs from Norfolk Island was invited to shepherd the flock, and with the help of the brethren from their near-by island, timber was secured and a neat little church erected and dedicated to the service of God.

During the past five years Brother and Sister Ferris, with the younger members of their family, have resided on the island and have endeared themselves to the hearts of these people by their unselfish ministry. A good sister has given a fine piece of ground for a site for a permanent residence for an Adventist worker, and this has been approved of by the governing council. In a beautiful valley under a towering cliff over 2000 feet high, and surrounded at the rear with beautiful foliage and a most enchanting sea view in front, stands a neat little home erected and occupied by our mission family. It was the privilege of Brother James and myself to spend Friday night, November 26, with this family and to meet with the company of about thirty believers in their nice little church.

As Lord Howe Island is becoming more and more popular as a tourist resort, it affords greater opportunities for mission work and thus should have a larger place in our interests. So let us continue to pray for the work and workers on this our nearest island field.

A. G. STEWART.

S.S. "Makambo,"
Nov. 27, 1926.

Missionary Correspondence

FOR the encouragement of others who engage in posting the *Signs* and missionary correspondence, we give below a letter just received by a young sister in reply to one she wrote to a lady whom she met while Ingathering and to whom she has since posted the *Signs of the Times*:

"I am answering your very kindly note, on behalf of my wife, and returning to you our best thanks and deep appreciation of your Christian courtesy in regularly forwarding to us the deeply interesting *Signs of the Times* periodical.

"The contents have made deep religious impressions on Mrs. F. and myself, and we recognise and lay to heart that the 'things which are seen are temporal; but the things which are not seen are eternal;' therefore we fervently trust that the Lord will reward you for the lofty sentiments which prompted you to act so generously toward us. We are pleased that you are different from the general type of dressy worldlings spending their time in self adulation and pleasure. Some day we shall reward you."

Relation of the Minister to the Canvassing Work

THE work in which we are engaged is one work, and this one work is the work of God. The relation, therefore, of the workers in the various lines, the one to the other, should be that of the different members of the human body, the one to the other. It is not for us to say which line of work is the most important. And so far as the different workers are concerned, one is just as important as the other, for although we are labourers together with God, yet the Lord declares that he that planteth and he that watereth is nothing. Each worker, then, in any line stands for nothing, but one nothing is just as much as any other nothing. Each and every one, therefore, is but an instrument in the hands of Him to whom the work belongs.

A great work of saving souls remains yet to be done. Every angel in glory is engaged in this work, while every demon of darkness is opposed to it. Christ has demonstrated to us the great value of souls, in that He came to the world with all the hoarded love of eternity in His heart, offering to make man heir to all His wealth. He unfolded before us the love of the Father for a guilty race, and presented Him as just and the justifier of him that believeth in Jesus, for Christ pleased not Himself. Since He pleased not Himself, it is not the business of any worker to please himself, but rather to please Him who hath chosen him to be a soldier, because "as He is, so are we in this world."

A Mistaken Idea

Unfortunately an idea has obtained to some extent that the canvassing work is less important, less dignified, and less desirable than that of the Bible worker or the minister; but such is not the case. The declaration of the Spirit of God that "if there is one work more important than another it is that of getting our publications before the public," means exactly what it says; and as to the dignity of any work, that is dependent very much upon how dignified the workers make it.

"The canvassing work is God's means of reaching many that would not otherwise be impressed with the truth. The work is a good one. The object is high and elevating, and there should be a corresponding dignity of deportment." Again, "The canvassing work is more important than many have regarded it;" and again, "The press is the instrument by which many are reached, whom it would be impossible to reach by ministerial effort." Every canvasser who appreciates the high and holy calling upon which he has entered, will not be affected by any influence exerted to make his work compare small or inferior to any other line of work; and any minister or Bible worker who is disposed in any way to belittle the canvassing work, and thus tend to weaken the hands of those engaged in it, is thereby, unconsciously maybe, "scattering abroad" instead of gathering with Christ in the great work of saving souls.

One Way in Which Ministers May Strengthen Their Work

The word to us is that "ministers need to understand much more than they now do of the practical workings of the cause in its various branches." It is an undeniable fact that since the development of the canvassing work, the minister has almost entirely ceased to sell our publications. Yet he has golden opportunities; the people listen with interest to what he has to say and the opportunity presents itself again to place in these homes a variety of our publications. Why should he not do so? Generally speaking, why should he not learn the business if he has not already done so? There are times in the ministry when he finds it difficult to reach the people in a public way, but at such times they may very often be reached by means of the printed page. In years gone by it was a common thing during a few weeks of tent meetings to sell from £20 to £75 worth of literature. But this is rarely if ever seen now. Is not this changed state of things worthy of our workers' consideration? And is it not possible for our ministers and Bible workers to do far more in this line than what they are doing at the present time? Would not this strengthen our work as ministers, and make our efforts more efficient in establishing souls in the truth? Not only so, but we would thereby the more closely link our interests and sympathies with the canvassers in their work, and so strengthen their hands. The ministers need lose none of their dignity if, when they find it difficult to get access to the people in a public way, they should for a time turn their efforts to the canvassing work. While they may counsel and encourage the canvasser in his work, they may in return receive valuable help which will enable them to be successful in placing the printed truth in the hands of the people as they have opportunity, and thus make their work more successful in winning and establishing souls in the truth. In this way the ministers and Bible workers identify themselves more fully with the canvasser, thus unifying the work. Not only so, but a far more valuable object lesson is kept before the church, and those embracing the truth, from whose ranks we are constantly receiving recruits for active workers in the field. If those just coming to the faith and joining the church can all see in the ministry a spirit of earnestness and courage in every branch of the work, it will inspire them with the same earnestness and zeal and make them active in soul-winning service.—*Selected.*

Notice

THE twelfth session and camp-meeting of the South New Zealand Conference will be held at the Addington Showgrounds, Christchurch, January 12-23, 1927. All church members in good and regular standing are constituted delegates, and are entitled to exercise their votes. A hearty invitation is extended to you to be present at all of these meetings.

A. S. HERBERT,
Secretary.

TO all who are reaching out to feel the guiding hand of God, the moment of greatest discouragement is the time when divine help is nearest.—"*The Desire of Ages,*" *p. 528.*

Canvassing

Monthly Summary of Australasian Canvassing Work

Victoria-Tasmania

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Bible Readings—			
J. A. Bown ...	58½	3	0 9 6
J. R. Brown ...	31	3	2 2 0
Home Nurses—			
E. M. Bernoth ...	113	66	115 5 0
E. M. Martin ...	90	13	20 14 6
C. Sinclair ...	23	15	35 19 0
S. H. Gander ...	56	28	69 15 0
Our Day—			
N. C. Harker ...	45½	13	20 0 0
E. M. Martin ...	70	11	11 13 0
Ladies' Handbook—			
R. A. Caldwell ...		30	48 15 0
J. A. Bown ...	5	1	1 12 6
Coming King—			
Miss A. Vogt ...	42	21	17 16 0
Seer of Patmos—			
M. Wilson ...	33½	38	12 16 0
House We Live In			
C. Sinclair ...		6	1 9 0
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			30 0 6
	567½	243	£395 18 0
Periodicals—			
Mrs. H. Devine ...	39½		£15 0 0
Mrs. E. Barron ...		75	5 17 0

South Australia

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Ladies' Handbook—			
Mrs. M. Badcock	51½	40	£38 15 0
Our Day—			
A. Bullas ...	36½	16	17 16 6
W. R. Burscott	68	14	17 1 0
L. P. Higginson	96¾	20	20 17 0
Home Nursing—			
Miss M. Luke (del)	8½	9	11 2 6
R. T. Watts ...	118½	39	38 19 6
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			11 3 2
	399¾	148	£195 18 8

West Australia

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Home Nursing			
Mrs. Ladd ...	41	25	30 8 6
E. R. Dodd ...	124½	44	55 61 6
Mrs. Kent ...	15½	12	14 11 6
J. R. Kent ...	66½	98	115 18 0
A. P. House ...	150	69	88 11 0
Our Day—			
V. Cole ...	28	14	13 17 6
Our Day and Parentheal Guide—			
G. T. Westwood	27	21	30 2 6
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			18 15 3
	445½	271	£357 15 9

North New Zealand

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Christ's Object Lessons—			
Mrs. Jennings (del.)	14	1	12 6
Daniel and Revelation—			
Mrs. E. Matthews	60	14	19 8 6
Miscellaneous	15½	1	1 1 0
Our Day—			
A. H. Kuhts	103½	52	60 16 0
W. Waterhouse	49½	10	11 25 6
W. Jebb	110½	17	18 13 0
Miss G. Marter	13	8	2 18 6
Miscellaneous		2	2 3 6
Great Controversy—			
C. A. Harrisment	35	9	11 2 6
Ladies' Handbook			
H. R. Whitford	51½	26	48 0 0
G. Bailey	119½	45	49 12 6
Home Nursing—			
Mrs. E. Wells	95½	45	52 5 0
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			33 17 0
	722½	215	£312 5 6
Life and Health—			
Mr. B. Davies	5		19 0

South New Zealand

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Ladies' Handbook—			
J. Shinn	71	37	£52 17 6
R. Barber (del.)			
Miss Hossack		1	1 7 3
Bible Readings—			
A. E. Woodley	14½	33	50 15 6
Anonymous		3	3 3 0
Our Day—			
T. Chick	38½	11	11 15 0
Home Nursing—			
Mrs. Woodley	16½	7	8 1 9
Miss Hossack	19	5	6 10 6
Anonymous		10	12 9 0
Christ's Object Lessons—			
Miss Ward	51	27	12 9 6
Mrs. Engelbrecht	45½	21	8 18 6
Anonymous		2	19 0
House We Live In—			
Mrs. Engelbrecht	6½	4	1 14 0
Practical Guide			
Anonymous		1	1 12 6
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			14 19 0
	287½	168	£186 0 6

Queensland

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Home Nursing—			
C. L. Rowland	131	56	74 2 0
Our Day—			
N. H. Spick ...	45	23	23 12 6
F. Richter ...	23	10	11 2 0
G. Weslake ...	51	30	31 14 6
Mrs. Newley ...	49	9	9 4 6
Miss A. Kraum ...	117	13	13 16 0
Miss M. Hougelele	14	6	5 8 0
F. M. Secretary	28½	25	24 19 6
Practical Guide—			
C. W. Phillips ...	3	1	1 7 6
Ladies' Handbook—			
Mr. & Mrs. Cooper	82	77	110 12 6
Mr. & Mrs. Hodgkinson	103	69	114 2 6
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			35 19 0
	649½	319	£486 1 6

South New South Wales

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Orders	Value
Our Day—			
L. C. Byrne ...	63	9	£9 18 0
E. Peare ...	25	13	16 0 6
E. Fayers ...	46	22	24 3 0
C. Nicholson ...	72	38	37 4 0
H. N. Moore ...	107½	92	100 2 0
Coming King—			
Miss N. Murphy	36	48	38 6 0
Miss Glazier ...	38½	29	22 13 0
H. D. Brown ...	5	8	6 3 0
Ladies' Handbook—			
C. J. de la Motte	92	85	126 11 6
B. Waldrom ...	51	55	77 12 6
Mrs. de la Motte	86	199	153 2 6
Home Nursing—			
G. Conduit ...	33	68	33 5 6
Ministry of Healing—			
Mrs. Frost ...	9	2	1 5 0
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			15 11 0
	526½	599	£752 4 6

North New South Wales

NOVEMBER, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
Coming King—			
S. Pennington ...		1	£ 13 6
S. Unley ...	106½	13	7 17 6
Our Day—			
A. Sabine ...	108	8	8 18 6
D. Brennan ...	67	17	17 5 0
F. Taylor ...	72	11	11 12 6
S. Pennington ...	37	9	6 18 0
Ladies' Handbook—			
W. V. Rees ...	133	54	78 4 6
Helps Sold by Colporteurs			8 3 0
	522½	111	£142 13 6

Book Totals for November, 1926

	Hrs.	Ord.	Value
North New Zealand ...	722½	215	312 5 6
South New South Wales	526½	599	752 4 6
Victoria-Tasmania ...	567½	243	395 18 0
West Australia ...	445½	271	357 15 9
North New South Wales	522½	111	142 13 6
South New Zealand ...	287½	168	186 0 6
South Australia ...	399¾	148	195 18 8
Queensland ...	649½	319	486 1 6
	4421	2073	£2778 11 11

Take Notice

THE thirty-ninth annual session of the Victorian Conference will be held in conjunction with the annual camp-meeting on the Royal Agricultural Showgrounds, Moonee Ponds, Melbourne, January 18 to 30, 1927. The first business meeting is planned for ten o'clock Wednesday morning, the 19th. A hearty invitation is extended to as many as possible to be present at these meetings.

W. G. TURNER,
President.

NOTHING is apparently more helpless, yet really more invincible, than the soul that feels its nothingness, relies wholly on the merits of the Saviour. God would send every angel in heaven to the aid of such an one, rather than allow him to be overcome.—"*Testimonies,*" *Vol. VII, p. 17*

SPECIAL

The Teacher's Encouragement

THE apostle John in his third epistle expresses himself in the words, "I have no greater joy than to hear that my children walk in truth." Into this experience it has been my privilege to enter. During the three months in which the Lord has thus far seen fit to lay me aside on a bed of sickness at the Sanitarium, opportunity has been given me to review the work of the twenty-four years in which I have been definitely connected with His cause.

These twenty-four years have been spent almost entirely in connection with our young people in educational work, from church school work upwards. To-day as I look over the Australasian field, yea, the world field, there is nothing that brings greater encouragement to me than to see scattered throughout the field young men and young women engaged actively in the Lord's service who have been for a longer or a shorter time under my instruction and direction in our schools. Of some of these I had the privilege of being the first teacher, giving them their first lessons. Now they are out on the battlefront, some even in the mission fields. There are presidents of local conferences, ordained ministers, ministerial and missionary licentiates, secretaries of the various departments both in the Union and local conferences, secretaries and treasurers of conferences, bookkeepers, stenographers, teachers, doctors, nurses, and workers in other capacities in our institutional and other lines of work, superintendents of mission fields in our own Australasian field and also in China and India, and missionaries in general. The wives of many of these workers, together with wives of other workers, must not be overlooked. While not taking any credit to myself for what these workers are, or may have done, and while regretting the many mistakes in my life and work that may have hindered further development, yet I esteem it a privilege to have had some part in helping them, either by way of instruction or counsel, and at such a time as this when one is laid aside and can do nothing himself, this gives one very great encouragement.

From many of these, letters of appreciation and sympathy have been received, and where it has been possible others have made me a personal visit in the Sanitarium. Some have ministered to my needs as nurses in the Sanitarium.

Besides these who are actively engaged in the Lord's organised work, I think of many others who are living the truth in their daily lives while engaged in private enterprises and who are assisting in their local churches.

Further word of encouragement comes in a letter received from one at one time under my instruction, expressing his appreciation of help given, speaking of how he likes to keep in touch with those who are keeping the standard flying even though he himself is not living the truth. While thus expressing himself, at the same time he says he hopes the day may come when he also will be found ranked side by side with those who are engaged in this high endeavour.

The instruction and counsel of the teacher may not always have all the desired effect upon every individual; some may pass for the time being, as it were, from under the influence, but the teacher has the encouragement of knowing that the seed has been sown and that in due time the Lord may cause that seed to take firm root, and cause it to spring up and bring forth fruit to His glory.

And now just a word in closing. While I know not what the Lord has in store for me, whether to continue longer in His service or to be laid to rest (His will be done), I would appeal to those who have passed from under my instruction through the years, and to our young people throughout this Australasian field in general, to make the service of God supreme in your lives. And then when the blessed Master returns we shall have many sheaves to present to Him, and in return He will place stars in our crowns. There may come dark periods in your experience, but do not let these weaken your trust in God nor your zeal for His service; but keep your eyes upon the One above all, who has set the example of loyal service, and He will bring you into the light.

"For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? Are not even ye in the presence of our Lord Jesus Christ at His coming? For ye are our glory and joy." I Thess. 2 : 19, 20.

JOSEPH MILLS.

Sydney Sanitarium,
Dec. 22, 1926.

SOUTH AUSTRALIA

PRESIDENT: L. D. A. LEMKE
SECRETARY: J. TODD

New Church at Murray Bridge

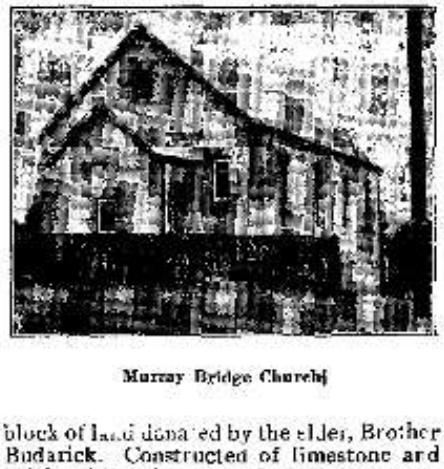
IT is just over thirteen months since the writer, accompanied by Brethren Potter and Sibley, began work in Murray Bridge. At that time we were not represented by even a Sabbath school.

Soon after work was commenced in the town we began to pray for a church company with a building of its own. God heard and answered prayer, as the accompanying photograph will testify.

Last April the first business meeting of this company was called, and it was decided to build a house to the glory of God in this river town. At that meeting the local brethren accepted the burden of raising £200 in six months—a goodly sum for a small membership, new to the faith. Not content with allowing the brethren to carry the whole of the burden of raising the money, the sisters very willingly came forward ready to assist. Under the leadership of Sister Budarick, the wife of the local elder, the sisters, commencing with 12s. 6d., cut, stitched, sewed, and sold, until they were able to pay into the building fund more than £34. The brethren too were willing to give all the help possible, and many hours were given to stone-raising, seat-making, clearing and fencing, while the carpentering, plumbing, painting, and finishing in its entirety were carried out by Brother Potter and the writer, who also assisted in digging some of the needed stone from the lap of Mother Earth. A friend, the husband of one of the local sisters, gave sufficient stone for the front wall; and two other young men installed the electric light, including all fittings, as a donation toward the funds.

Of the work in Murray Bridge it can rightly be said, "They helped every one his neighbour; and every one said to his brother, Be of good courage."

The joy of both workers and church members reached high-water mark on December 4 when the building was dedicated to the worship of the most high God. The structure is nicely situated in one of the main streets of Murray Bridge, on a



Murray Bridge Church

block of land donated by the elder, Brother Budarick. Constructed of limestone and brick, with a freestone front, a conservative estimate sets the value at £750.

Visitors from Nuriootpa, Gawler, Black Swamp, Adelaide, and suburbs were in attendance at the dedicatory service. Brother Hamilton and his band of singers from the city of Adelaide provided a musical treat for the local church members.

The first meeting was held in the new building at 10.30 Sabbath morning, when Pastor Steed spoke on "Reverence in the House of God." At 3 p.m. with the church well filled Pastor Lemke conducted the dedicatory service. And what a feast it was! All felt the presence of the Holy Spirit in that meeting, which was demonstrated by a ready response to the call for a full surrender and a rededication of the life to the Lord for service.

The special meetings reached a finality on Sunday, December 5, when Pastor Lemke delivered a lantern lecture in the new building, and as we saw evidences of the Spirit of God working among the natives of the South Seas, we felt like saying, "What hath God wrought!"

We earnestly pray that God will make the new building in Murray Bridge a bright beacon that will lead others to the path of truth; and as we turn our attention once more to the aggressive mission work, we pray that God will send us back from the field bearing heavy sheaves for His heavenly garner.

S. L. PATCHING.

SOUTH NEW SOUTH WALES

PRESIDENT: G. G. STEWART
SECRETARY: W. H. HOPKIN

Dedication of Hurstville Church Building

FOR years we had prayed and planned and worked for this day,—the day when we should have a house of worship dedicated to His service in the Hurstville district.

On December 5, 1926, the dedicatory service was conducted by Pastors A. H. Piper, A. H. White, H. Mitchell, and G. G. Stewart, the president of this conference. Despite the very hot weather the church was well filled with representatives from a number of our suburban churches, also friends not of our faith.

Pastor H. Mitchell opened the service with a psalm of praise, which was an expression of our feelings toward our Heavenly Father. Brother G. Hayes, the church building treasurer, gave a very clear report of the financial standing of the church. He had a large chart printed and placed in the church where all could see. This chart showed at a glance how much money had been received, how much had been expended, and how much we still owed.

During the service we were favoured with two trios rendered by Sisters Shannon and Hardwicke and Brother Osborne, which were appreciated by all.

Pastor Piper in his dedicatory address explained to us the meaning of the word "sanctuary" (a dwelling place for God) and that God, if we would allow Him, would make our hearts His dwelling place.

The offering was £16 6s. 4d., for which we thank our good people and friends, also for the loyal help they have rendered us in the past.

Pastor White offered the dedicatory prayer, and after we had sung our last hymn Pastor Stewart closed the service with prayer.

H. MACFARLANE,
Church Clerk.

An Appeal

THE article in this issue of the RECORD dealing with the relation of the ministry to the canvassing work is very timely. There never has been a time in our book work when we did not stand in need of the helpful co-operation of ministers, evangelists, and church leaders. And those of us who have spent years in that work have very much appreciated all that has come to the book work in the way of encouragement to the work and workers as a result of practical sympathy and appreciation of the value of the work done by the faithful colporteurs. But, as the great and wonderful work of the last gospel message has to be carried on now as it never has been before, and as the world is to receive the light of truth through the evangelising ministry of the Word in our books and periodicals, we stand in special need of the help and influence that can be given to this work by ministers and leaders in our churches to encourage the sale of publications that deal with Bible subjects, the teaching of which will prepare people to stand, having their loins girded with truth and their lamps burning. To that end we appeal for the help of all our leaders to encourage the faithful workers now in the field by recognising in a practical way the value of the work they are doing, and also to encourage others to step out and join the ranks of those doing active work in sowing the seed. We have the assurance, "They that sow in tears shall reap in joy. He that goeth forth and weepeth, bearing the seed basket, shall doubtless come again with rejoicing, bringing his sheaves with him."

J. M. J.

He Was Ready

I HAVE just returned from prayer meeting. One of the old-fashioned kind where men and women PRAY and give their testimony to the goodness of God. Most of those present had been visiting their neighbours during the week, talking to them about Bible truths, handing out literature, and soliciting for the Ingathering work. Their faces fairly shone as they related these experiences, and they had something to tell which was worth listening to.

One brother had recently entered a chemist shop to make a purchase. After the usual casual greetings with the person in charge, conversation drifted to world conditions, and then our brother was asked as to what he thought of the state of the dead. In a conversational way a real study was given on this subject. Customers came, telephone calls must be answered, but he was asked to wait and continue the talk, which he did for about an hour. Later on the man visited the shop again, and this man then told him how greatly he appreciated the previous talk, and how it had helped him understand the Bible.

Others told of experiences, showing that there are hungry souls all about us, and anxious enquiries are being made concerning our belief.

How about you, friend? Are you able to give an intelligent answer when such enquiries come unexpectedly? More and more we may expect this. As the judgments of God come in the land, the people will look to us for help. Shall we disappoint them? Just before the end we are told that "hundreds and thousands were seen visiting families, and opening before them the Word of God. . . . On every side doors were thrown open to the proclamation of the truth." Also, "Every truly converted soul will be intensely desirous to bring others from the darkness of error into the marvellous light of the righteousness of Jesus Christ."

As we thought of these things, and realised our unpreparedness, fifteen of those present felt their need of just such help as is being offered by the Fireside Correspondence School, in its course on "How to Prepare and Conduct Bible Readings." They enrolled and plan to get together to study these lessons, and so better fit themselves to meet these emergencies, also to be of real practical, intelligent help to their pastor in their next tent effort.

"In addition to our schools, the church must become a training centre. From among its members capable workers must be developed."—"*Testimonies,*" *Vol. IX, p. 140.* What would it mean if every church had these little study circles? May we help you to organise? Individually and collectively let us take hold of this work earnestly. Let us finish the work and go home.

LIZZIE M. GREGG.

OBITUARIES

PARKINSON.—Albert Edward Parkinson, born at Ballarat, Vic., died at Cooranbong, N.S.W., on December 16, aged sixty-eight years, and was laid to rest in the Avondale cemetery. Mr. Parkinson was a son of Sister Parkinson-Wainman, a Bible worker in the early days of our work in Australia. He came to Cooranbong with Brethren Daniells, Palmer, and others, at their invitation, to select the present College site. We extend sympathy to his wife, Sister Penrose Parkinson, who is a member of the Avondale church.

W. W. FLETCHER.

SALT.—Thirty-five years ago on Norfolk Island, during the labours of Pastor Reed, Sister Sarah Eunice Salt made the great choice of her life when she surrendered all to Jesus. Removing to New Zealand two years later and settling in Kaeo, North Auckland, she became one of the first members in the pioneer church of the North Island. Last October Sister Salt's health necessitated her removal to the Auckland hospital, where she was visited by Brother Foster and the writer. On Sunday, the day preceding her death, she expressed her confidence and faith in her Saviour. The following morning she fell asleep with the blessed assurance that she will hear the voice of the Life-giver calling her to a new life and a larger service in the earth made new. Two days later, in the presence of her family and a large number of sorrowing friends, a short service was conducted by the writer in the home of one of her daughters and at the graveside in the Otahuhu cemetery, where the husband and children were pointed to Him who can, and who does, comfort "as one whom his mother comforteth." She being dead, yet speaketh, for her husband has been led by her Christlike example to return to the fold of Christ, and one of her daughters has asked for studies that she too may know, love, and serve her mother's Saviour. Three sons (one of whom, William, is elder of our church at Feilding), two daughters, and their father are left to mourn the loss of a faithful wife and mother.

J. HOOKINGS.

Australasian Record

THE OFFICIAL ORGAN OF THE
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BROTHER AND SISTER A. H. BATEMAN returned from New Guinea during the last week of the old year. After a short furlough Brother Bateman will connect with the work at the Sanitarium, Wahroonga.

THE sad news has reached us of the death of Sister Rudge, senior, wife of Pastor P. B. Rudge, which occurred on Friday afternoon December 24, at Kempsey, where Brother and Sister Rudge have been labouring for the aborigines. Having received word of her illness, their son, Brother Victor Rudge, and daughter, Mrs. T. W. Carr, of Wahroonga, were about to leave for Kempsey when another telegram was received announcing her death. They were able to be present at the funeral. We extend our deepest sympathy to Brother Rudge and all the members of the bereaved family. Fuller particulars will be given later.

"THE TEACHER'S ENCOURAGEMENT," on another page of this paper, was dictated by Pastor Joseph Mills, while on his sick-bed at the Sanitarium and will be of interest to our readers. We are sorry to report that Brother Mills, who has been in the Sanitarium since September is in a very critical condition of health, and unless the Lord intervenes, his life cannot be prolonged more than a few weeks. In response to special prayer on his behalf, the Lord gave signal evidence of His presence and blessing. This has proved a comfort to Brother and Sister Mills, helping them to realise that his case is in the Lord's hands and that His will, whatever it be, will be done.

A PARTY of missionaries sailed from Sydney for the Solomon Islands, December 22 by the *Mataram*. The company comprised Pastor H. B. P. Wicks, Brother and Sister A. R. Barrett, Brother and Sister A. J. Campbell, and Pana. Brother Barrett's health having improved since the Union Conference session, it was felt that he could return to the Solomons, and hence his appointment to the Society Islands (a non-malarial field) was rescinded. Brother and Sister Barrett greatly rejoice in being able to return to the field of their former labours, and will receive a very warm welcome as they again take charge of our Solomon Island Training School, at Batuna. Brother and Sister A. J. Campbell are going out as new workers to that field. Pana's visit to Australia has been greatly appreciated by all who have had the privilege of meeting him.

More Warburton Notes

A LATEST-MODEL Ford car was presented to the Sanitarium some months ago by a patient, Mr. George Ryland—"Uncle George," as he likes to be called by the staff. This motor car has proved a great boon to the institution. Not only has it proved useful for conveying patients from and to the railway station, but it has been of inestimable value to the nurses, often saving them miles of walking when called to outside cases. For night work it has been a great convenience. Mr. Ryland's useful gift is much appreciated.

Sabbath School and Church

The Sabbath school offerings this quarter (October-December) promise at the time of writing (December 21) to be a record. The offerings for the first eleven Sabbaths totalled £54 5s. 4d. On account of the coming Christmas holidays, the Thirteenth Sabbath offering was taken up on the twelfth Sabbath, December 18, and amounted to £43 13s. 9d., in addition to which there was £2 12s. in the birthday box. This makes a total for the twelve Sabbaths of £100 14s. 1d. As there is, at the time of writing, still a Sabbath to come, it looks as if the record made the previous quarter of £104 1s. 10d. will be exceeded.

Brother Howard Davis, the linotype operator in the Publishing House, has been our Sabbath school superintendent for the two quarters mentioned. He has had willing assistants in Brother Fred Ward, of the Publishing House, and Brother T. F. Harrison, of the Health Food Factory.

Leading brethren who have taken preaching services in the church since the Union Conference session are Pastor W. G. Turner, president of the Victorian Conference, and Pastor H. C. White, who with his wife and family, stayed at the Sanitarium over the week-end on his way to the presidency of the West Australian Conference. Pastor Turner, rich in a harvest of wonderful facts from the General Conference, preached us a most inspiring sermon showing the wonderful way in which God is going before this movement. There is even more than "the sound of a going in the tops of the mulberry trees" in God's work today. The inspiring reports and the remarkable array of extraordinary facts presented by Pastor Turner show that God is doing great things for His work and people. Truly the time has come to apply William Carey's great motto, "Attempt great things for God, expect great things from God."

We were pleased to have with us, for a few days during Young People's Week, Brother Leonard Simpson, from the Australasian Missionary College, and Brother W. G. Gilson, secretary of the Victorian Missionary Volunteer Department. Each gave addresses that were much appreciated.

The Publishing House

We were sorry to say "Good-bye" to Pastor and Mrs. J. M. Johanson and their daughter Thelma, on their leaving Warburton for Wahroonga, where Pastor Johanson has taken up his duties as general manager of the Australasian Conference Association Limited. We are pleased, however, to welcome their son, Brother W. O. Johanson, the new manager of the Signs Publishing Company, who with his wife and family are now settled among us.

The Publishing House has been kept busy with reprints of our message-filled books, the printing of the *Signs* and the *Life and Health* and the *Colporteur*, while the edition of the 1927 *Appeal for Missions* ran to 135,000 copies. The printing of the *Appeal* necessitated some overtime work. In addition, much work has been done in printing supplies for the Health Food Factory.

In order to cope with the growing work, some changes have been necessary in the building, thus enlarging the space for the factory work. A new Miehle cylinder press is expected to arrive from America at the end of this month (December), and will be installed early in the new year.

When these notes appear, the time will have about come to set up the copy for the March-April issue of *Life and Health*. An old gentleman in New South Wales—not of our faith—eighty years of age, who has been a total abstainer and a non-smoker all his life and a vegetarian for the past forty years, writes very appreciatively of the article, "How to Get Rid of the Cigarette Habit," in the November-December, 1926, issue of *Life and Health*. Those of our people who are not yet subscribers to our health journal should become subscribers right away, thus missing nothing of the good things the paper will contain during 1927.

A. L. KING.

Appreciation

PASTOR AND MRS. J. MILLS desire to express their deep gratitude to the many kind friends who have sent messages of sympathy and love by letter, by telegram, and by bouquets of flowers during Brother Mills' present illness, and for the many prayers that are being constantly offered for his recovery if it should be the Lord's will. It is impossible for answers to be written to all the many letters that have come in, and they desire that these friends shall accept this note as an expression of their appreciation.

Important Dates

Camp-Meetings:
- North New Zealand: Dec. 28 to Jan. 9, 1927.
- South New Zealand: January 12-23.
- Victoria: January 18-30.
- Tasmania: February 3-13.
- West Australia: Feb. 22 to March 6.
- South Australia: March 8-20.
- North N.S.W.: March 1-13.
- Fiji "Boso": June 16-20.
- Indian Meeting: June 10-12.
- Queensland: To be arranged.

Educational Day: January 15, 1927.
A. M. College opens Feb. 23, 1927.
Appeal for Missions: March 5—
Sabbath School Rally Day: April 24.
Week of Prayer: June 4-11.

AS we near the close of time, Satan's temptation to indulge appetite will be more powerful and more difficult to overcome.—"*Testimonies*," *Vol. III, p. 491.*